

TB AUDIO PLUG-INS
Team Impulse Impact

USER MANUAL

TB Exciter

Harmonic Exciter and Enhancer

Adds a clean, open high-frequency layer that begins at a chosen focus frequency, with control over its amount, its warm-to-clear character, and its stereo width.

Focus 500 Hz to 6 kHz

Warm-to-clear CLARITY

Width of the added layer

30 factory presets



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01 Overview

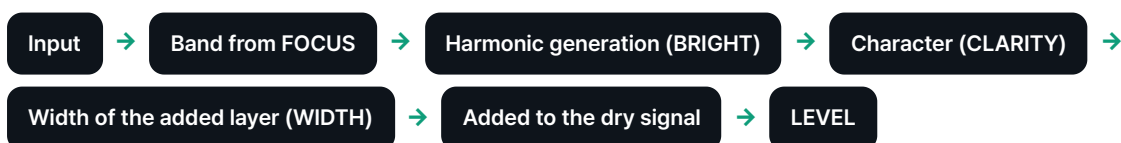
TB Exciter generates new high-frequency detail from the sound you feed it and adds it on top of the original. It brightens and clarifies vocals, mixes, drums, and instruments by creating upper harmonics, not only by boosting what is already there.

Five controls cover it: **FOCUS** sets where the enhancement begins, **BRIGHT** sets how much is added, **CLARITY** moves its character from warm to clear, **WIDTH** sets the stereo width of the added layer, and **LEVEL** sets the output. The original signal always passes through underneath, so there is no separate mix control.

Key features

- FOCUS from 500 Hz to 6 kHz selects where the enhancement begins
- BRIGHT sets the amount of added high-frequency content
- CLARITY moves its character from warm (0%) to clear (100%)
- WIDTH from mono (0%) through the original width (100%) to wide (200%), for the added layer only
- LEVEL from -12 to +12 dB
- SPARKLE FIELD display
- 30 factory presets in five groups, recalled with your project

Signal flow



About this manual

This manual describes TB Exciter 1.1.0 for Windows (VST3), including the DSP refinement released on 2026-09-30. The current macOS build (AU and VST3) is version 1.0.1 and may differ.

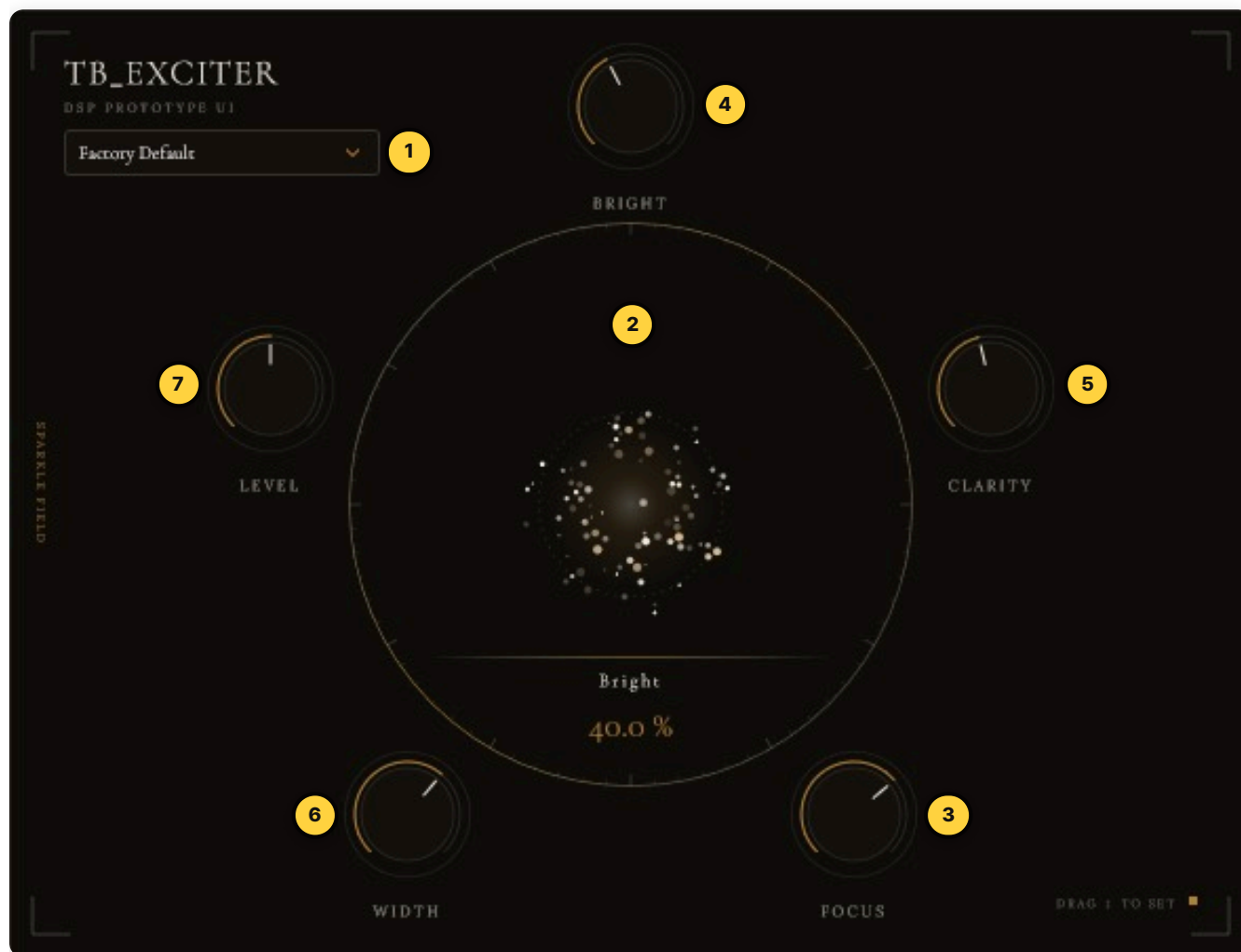
02 Quick start

- 1 Insert TB Exciter on a vocal, bus, drum, or instrument track. The Factory Default preset uses **FOCUS** 3 kHz, **BRIGHT** 40%, **CLARITY** 45%, **WIDTH** 130%, and **LEVEL** 0 dB.
- 2 Pick a starting point from the preset selector **1**.

- 3 Set **FOCUS** 3 to where the enhancement should begin: lower settings reach into presence, higher settings add only air.
- 4 Raise **BRIGHT** 4 until the detail comes forward, then choose the character with **CLARITY** 5.
- 5 Adjust **WIDTH** 6 if the added layer should be narrower or wider, and match the bypassed level with **LEVEL** 7.

Drag a knob to set it, as the DRAG TO SET hint at the lower right reminds you.

03 Interface



TB Exciter 1.1 interface with the Factory Default preset.

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|--|---|
| 1 Preset selector — the 30 factory presets by group; shows Custom after you change a control. | 4 BRIGHT — the amount of enhancement. |
| 2 SPARKLE FIELD — a visual of the added high-frequency layer, with a control name and its value underneath. | 5 CLARITY — warm to clear character. |
| 3 FOCUS — where the enhancement begins. | 6 WIDTH — stereo width of the added layer. |
| | 7 LEVEL — output level. |

04 Controls

Control	Range · default	What it does
FOCUS	500 Hz to 6 kHz · 3 kHz	Selects where the high-frequency enhancement begins. It is not an EQ cutoff for the whole signal. The range stops at 6 kHz because harmonics generated above that would fall outside the audible range.
BRIGHT	0 to 100% · 40%	Controls the amount of high-frequency enhancement. High settings can sound harsh and also raise the level.
CLARITY	0 to 100% · 45%	Moves the added high-frequency character from warm (0%) to clear (100%). It is a character control, not an EQ tilt.
WIDTH	0 to 200% · 130%	Controls the stereo width of the added high-frequency layer: 0% is mono, 100% the original width, and 200% wide. It does not widen the dry signal.
LEVEL	-12 to +12 dB · 0 dB	Adjusts the plug-in's output level. It is not a limiter or an automatic loudness match.

TB Exciter reports 61 samples of latency (about 1.3 ms at 48 kHz). Hosts with delay compensation keep it in time with other tracks.

An exciter makes a sound louder as well as brighter. Match the level with LEVEL before you compare with bypass, so you judge the tone and not the loudness. Most factory presets lower LEVEL slightly for this reason.

05 Presets

Choose a factory preset from the selector at the top left. The presets are grouped into ESSENTIAL, MIX / MASTER, VOCAL, DRUMS, and INSTRUMENTS. After you change a control, the selector shows Custom. The chosen preset is recalled with your project. TB Exciter has no user preset files; use your host's preset function to store your own settings.

Group	Preset	FOCUS	BRIGHT	CLARITY	WIDTH	LEVEL
ESSENTIAL	Factory Default	3 kHz	40%	45%	130%	0 dB
ESSENTIAL	Barely There	4.2 kHz	18%	55%	105%	0 dB
ESSENTIAL	Soft Gold	3.2 kHz	30%	15%	110%	-0.2 dB
ESSENTIAL	Mono Sparkle	3 kHz	42%	55%	0%	-0.5 dB
ESSENTIAL	Open Air	4.6 kHz	48%	68%	135%	-0.5 dB
ESSENTIAL	Dark Track Rescue	1.8 kHz	62%	58%	120%	-1 dB
MIX / MASTER	Mix Bus Polish	3.6 kHz	34%	42%	110%	-0.3 dB
MIX / MASTER	Mix Bus Clarity	3.4 kHz	44%	78%	115%	-0.4 dB
MIX / MASTER	Warm Master Silk	4.8 kHz	28%	18%	100%	-0.2 dB
MIX / MASTER	Clear Master Air	5.2 kHz	30%	88%	100%	-0.2 dB
MIX / MASTER	Dense Mix Unveil	2.4 kHz	52%	72%	125%	-0.7 dB

Group	Preset	FOCUS	BRIGHT	CLARITY	WIDTH	LEVEL
MIX / MASTER	Vintage Top Glue	2.6 kHz	46%	8%	105%	−0.5 dB
VOCAL	Lead Vocal Air	3.8 kHz	54%	76%	105%	−0.7 dB
VOCAL	Intimate Vocal Glow	2.2 kHz	36%	25%	95%	−0.3 dB
VOCAL	Female Vocal Shine	3.2 kHz	46%	62%	120%	−0.5 dB
VOCAL	Male Vocal Presence	1.7 kHz	42%	55%	100%	−0.5 dB
VOCAL	Background Vocal Wide	4.2 kHz	56%	66%	175%	−0.8 dB
VOCAL	Breath & Whisper	5.5 kHz	68%	90%	145%	−1.2 dB
DRUMS	Drum Bus Snap	2 kHz	48%	74%	100%	−0.7 dB
DRUMS	Snare Crack	1.4 kHz	60%	82%	105%	−1.1 dB
DRUMS	Cymbal Silk	4.4 kHz	38%	20%	120%	−0.4 dB
DRUMS	Cymbal Detail	4.8 kHz	50%	86%	140%	−0.7 dB
DRUMS	Percussion Wide	3 kHz	58%	58%	180%	−0.9 dB
DRUMS	Lo-Fi Hats Restore	2.6 kHz	74%	72%	150%	−1.5 dB
INSTRUMENTS	Acoustic String Detail	2.7 kHz	44%	45%	115%	−0.5 dB
INSTRUMENTS	Electric Guitar Edge	1.6 kHz	38%	38%	100%	−0.4 dB
INSTRUMENTS	Piano Hammer Air	3.9 kHz	42%	72%	160%	−0.4 dB
INSTRUMENTS	Synth Halo	4.8 kHz	78%	88%	200%	−1.8 dB
INSTRUMENTS	Bass Definition	900 Hz	34%	65%	100%	−0.5 dB
INSTRUMENTS	Orchestral Sheen	4 kHz	46%	30%	130%	−0.5 dB

06 Recipes

Starting points for common jobs. Adjust them by ear.

Vocal air

Open, breathy top end on a lead vocal.

Preset Lead Vocal Air

FOCUS 3.5 to 4.5 kHz

BRIGHT 40 to 55%

- 1 If sibilance gets sharper, lower BRIGHT or place a de-esser before TB Exciter.

Mix bus polish

Gentle sheen on a full mix.

Preset Mix Bus Polish

BRIGHT 25 to 35%

WIDTH 100 to 110%

- 1 Compare at matched level; small amounts go a long way on a mix.

Snare crack

More bite on a dull snare.

Preset	Snare Crack
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FOCUS	1.2 to 2 kHz
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CLARITY	70 to 85%
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1 Use LEVEL to offset the extra level; the preset uses -1.1 dB.

Bass definition

A bass line that reads on small speakers.

Preset	Bass Definition
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FOCUS	around 900 Hz
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WIDTH	100%
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1 Keep WIDTH at 100% or lower so the low end stays centered.

07 Tips and troubleshooting

Symptom	What to check
The highs sound harsh or brittle.	Lower BRIGHT, or move CLARITY toward warm.
Sibilance gets louder.	Lower BRIGHT, or place a de-esser before TB Exciter.
It sounds louder but not better.	Match the level with LEVEL before comparing with bypass.
The added layer is too wide or weak in mono.	Lower WIDTH to 100% or below; 0% makes the added layer mono.
The effect is hard to hear.	Raise BRIGHT or lower FOCUS. The source may have little content near the FOCUS frequency.
The track is slightly late against others.	TB Exciter reports 61 samples of latency; turn on delay compensation in your host.
The selector shows Custom.	A control was changed after the preset was loaded. Choose the preset again to restore it.

08 Parameter reference

Panel label	Host parameter	Range	Default
FOCUS	Focus	500 to 6000 Hz	3000 Hz
BRIGHT	Bright	0 to 100%	40%
CLARITY	Clarity	0 to 100%	45%
WIDTH	Width	0 to 200%	130%
LEVEL	Level	-12 to +12 dB	0 dB

09 Version history

Version	Changes
1.1.0 · 2026-09-30	DSP refinement for a clean, open upper-air sound, with a resonance-safe detector edge at 16.97 kHz and a re-validated 30-preset VST3 bundle. Reports 61 samples of latency.
1.1.0 · 2026-08-09	Compact 590 × 450 interface with an accessible factory preset selector; 30 categorized factory presets with host-notified parameter changes, edited-state tracking, and recall; the five public parameters and the host program count unchanged for project compatibility.

10 Support and license

Report problems or request features at github.com/TaebeumKim/TB_Audio-Plugins/issues. Include the plug-in version, your DAW, and your operating system.

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